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Learning to Navigate the Landscape of Participation

On the Initiation of Students into Practices of Entrepreneurship (and) Education

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Abstract

Practicing entrepreneurship is important for entrepreneurial learning in institutionalized education. However, research is attentive to how this challenges conventional learning arrangements and requires teachers and students to change familiar ways of relating and participating. In this study, we investigate the landscape of participation in a case of experiential entrepreneurship education for non-business postgraduate students. Employing the notion of legitimate peripheral participation in communities of practice, we show how students are initiated into entrepreneurship education practice through three modes of participation: compliance, autonomy and authenticity. Even though these participatory modes make sense one by one, their accumulation created tension. Hereby, we illustrate the complex organization of entrepreneurship education as situated social practices. We theorize by employing a practice theory perspective to explore why tensions may be inherent to widely recognized ideals of best practice in experiential entrepreneurship education. This is in contrast to individual learner oriented explanations.

Keywords: Entrepreneurship Education, Legitimate Peripheral Participation, Practice theories, Non-business students, Ethnography

Introduction

The ability to behave and think in an entrepreneurial way is viewed as a 'twenty-first century skill' (Obschonka et al. 2017, 40) and one of the 'meta competencies' (Blenker et al. 2011) that young people will need to develop in life to succeed in the modern labour market (Hahn et al. 2017). Therefore, a growing scholarship discusses how entrepreneurial learning can be effectively stimulated in higher education (Hägg and Gabrielsson 2019; Nabi et al. 2017).

Generally, it is accepted that entrepreneurial learning can be accessed best through engagement in real entrepreneuring practices beyond the classroom (Thrane et al. 2016; Johannisson 2016). Students learn 'through' entrepreneurship as they act, experience, and reflect in their own entrepreneurial process (Hägg and Kurczewska 2016; Pittaway and Cope 2007). Hence, it is trusted that effective EE requires a connection of entrepreneuring practices and practices of education. However, EE research reports how this connection challenges traditional education practice and the roles and relations of teachers and students (Jones, Penaluna, and Penaluna 2019; Henry 2020; Verzat, O'Shea, and Jore 2017) and how there can be a mismatch between what teachers want and expect from students and what students actually produce (Neck and Corbett 2018). For example, it is widely assumed that conventional student attitudes and behaviours are 'barriers' to entrepreneurial learning (Günzel-Jensen and Robinson 2017; Löbler 2006), and tensions arise when participants in EE act as 'students' when they should act as 'entrepreneurial agents' (Harima, Kroczak, and Repnik 2021; Frederiksen and Berglund 2020), self-directed in their acquisition of information and responsible for their own learning (Neck and Corbett 2018). Still, it is acknowledged that students may be unwilling or even unable to practice this learner oriented ideal (Jones, Penaluna, and Penaluna 2019). For that reason, there is a growing understanding in EE scholarship that to create access to entrepreneurial learning in a higher education context, it is important first to enable the students to participate as competent

practitioners in EE. Hence, it is recognized that access to entrepreneurial learning requires an initiation of participants not only into practices of entrepreneurship, but also into practices of entrepreneurship education (Jones, Penaluna, and Penaluna 2019).

In this article, we direct a practice theory perspective on EE, as we employ Lave and Wenger's (1991) concept of 'legitimate peripheral participation' (LPP) to investigate the initiation of participants into practices of experiential EE. This distinguishes our study from other EE research, which typically focuses on proper processes of instruction and ideal entrepreneurial learning environments (Jones, Penaluna, and Penaluna 2019; Pittaway and Cope 2007) or individuals and the cognitive reorganizations they take away from education (Verzat, O'Shea, and Jore 2017; Hahn et al. 2017). We seek to contribute to this literature by re-specifying EE in terms of practices and their relations (Thompson, Verduijn, and Gartner 2020). We ask: How are students enabled to act and be recognized as competent participants in experiential entrepreneurship education practice? Hence, we understand initiation in terms of students' enablement and how they come to be able to take part in practices (Alkemeyer and Buschmann 2016). Yet, we move the unit of analysis beyond the structure of the learning arrangement and individual participants, towards socially accomplished practices and their relations (Nicolini 2017; Schatzki 2017).

Aligned with theorizations of situated learning, we take the view that the enablement of participants is anchored in access to participation in a community of practice (CoP) and therefore is part and parcel of their changing participation in changing practices within social arrangements that are also changing in the process (Lave and Wenger 1991). Consequently, the object of our study is what Lave (2019, 135) calls the 'textured landscape of participation'. With that follows the understanding that participation can be multifaceted, can intersect, overlap or interfere. Hence, we investigate initiation into EE practices by addressing modes of participation afforded and

developed in the 'happeningness' of experiential EE as a particular practice arrangement (Grootenboer, Edwards-Groves, and Choy 2017).

The study builds on ethnographic fieldwork in a postgraduate course of experiential EE for non-business students. We found that students were initiated into practicing the learner orientation typically advanced in the EE literature through three modes of participation: compliance, autonomy and authenticity. Even though these modes made sense one by one, their accumulation created tension and the students disconnected what they saw as practices of entrepreneuring from what they saw as practices of education. Consequently, we contribute to understanding why best practice ideals in experiential EE are full of tensions. By adopting a non-individual lens, we surface these tensions analytically as effects of relational and collaborative sensemaking in the everyday happeningness of intersecting practices in and across CoPs.

The rest of the paper is structured as follows: First, we create an overview of how EE research generally discusses access to entrepreneurial learning in higher education and present how practice theory makes way for new insights to this discussion. Then, we present our research setting and methods for data collection and analysis, followed by our findings of three modes of participation. We discuss how the findings contribute to the literature on EE by challenging discussions on central assumptions regarding its practice. Additionally, we contribute to the relevance of situated learning as a practice theory perspective on higher education as we forward an understanding of LPP in terms of practical coping in and across CoPs. Finally, we draw up conclusions and implications for future research.

Learning Entrepreneurship in Higher Education Institutions

Educational initiatives always involve judgments of possible and desirable learning outcomes as well as of the means to achieve them (Lave and Packer 2008). Judgments of purpose and outcomes have expanded considerably in the field of EE, from teaching skills related to business start-up, survival and growth to introducing entrepreneurship as a method and approach to life in general (Gibb 2002; Sarasvathy and Venkataraman 2011). Entrepreneurship has transformed from a subject taught in business schools into an approach for learning in multiple academic fields (Turner and Gianiodis 2018) and embedded as mandatory modules in education programmes (Von Graevenitz, Harhoff, and Weber 2010). However, it is a complex educational task to develop entrepreneurial knowledge, attributes and behaviours in students, and EE scholars agree that traditional methods for teaching and learning in higher education are not suitable for this task (Hägg and Gabrielsson 2019). Indeed, the education system is sometimes held responsible for the lack of enterprise in its graduates (Löbler 2006). The literature thus asserts a need for pedagogical innovation and experimentation to create access for students to entrepreneurial learning in higher education (Rae 2010). Specifically, the literature forwards two vital requirements. One relates to the learning arrangements and the exposure of students to entrepreneurship practices. Another relates to the constitution and collaboration of particularly figured participants in this context.

Access to learning through exposure to entrepreneurship practices

EE research and practice recognize that the organization of learning environments play an important role as an enabler or a barrier to entrepreneurial learning (Johannisson 2016; Löbler 2006). Within the last three decades, scholarly debate on how to teach and learn entrepreneurship in institutionalised education has shifted attention away from traditional means of instructing and delivering content in classrooms towards facilitating experiential learning through alternative

learner-oriented methods and action-oriented teaching models (Hägg and Gabrielsson 2019). The importance of alignment between how entrepreneurs and entrepreneurship students learn has made research delve into the opportunities to mimic environments in which 'real' entrepreneurs learn (Pittaway and Cope 2007). That means engaging students in entrepreneuring activities outside the university, enabling them to truly experience, reflect and learn in and from an entrepreneurship process (Hägg and Kurczewska 2016). Hence, they should not be left in school with text books that do not reflect the learning needs of 'real entrepreneurs' (Edelman, Manolova, and Brush 2008). Neither, should they rely on a 'just do it' mode beyond school, rushing into entrepreneurial activities with no theoretical backing or reflection (Hägg and Kurczewska 2016; Warhuus, Blenker, and Elmholdt 2018). Ideally, effective arrangements in EE connect entrepreneuring and education practices for entrepreneurial learning purposes (Pittaway and Cope 2007).

Access to learning through collaboration between particular pre-figured participants

The call for connection of entrepreneuring and education practices in EE has opened a wider discussion about educator and student behaviours and relations. Typically, experiential EE operates with a distinction between the teacher-facilitated and theoretically supported learning arrangement, and the learning that students are to create. Thrane et al. (2016) point out how teachers must adapt the entrepreneurship process to an education context and translate it into a teaching and learning model providing a theoretical framework, a shared vocabulary and feedback mechanisms. The teacher thus takes on a 'filtering role' (Henry 2020, 668) with an outset in his or her personal perspective on entrepreneurship, determining what and how to teach, to whom and for what purpose (Fayolle and Gailly 2008). Yet, it is commonly argued that rather than knowledge transmitters, teachers should act as process facilitators, coaches or catalysts (Neck and Corbett 2018). With a focus on 'how' students learn entrepreneurially, teachers should guide the learning

process, but hold back from controlling the students' learning outcomes (Thrane et al. 2016). Students are expected to be proactive and self-directed in their acquisition of information and to be responsible for their own learning (Kyrö 2015). Hence, EE celebrates students' personal drives and autonomy in defining learning goals and the means to achieve these goals (van Gelderen 2010). Consequently, when it comes to creating access to entrepreneurial learning, the literature signals a requirement to rethink deeply rooted understandings of what it means to be a teacher and a student in higher education.

To facilitate and nurture such changes, a stream of literature points towards learning theories emphasizing those shifts required of students and teachers. It argues that since 'pedagogy' emphasizes knowledge transfer from educator to students, it is inappropriate when it comes to describing how access to entrepreneurial learning should be created in education (Jones et al. 2014; Jones, Penaluna, and Penaluna 2019). Instead, scholars suggest other terms, which explicitly emphasize limited teacher control of what should be learnt. For example, 'andragogy' emphasises student self-directedness and autonomy vis-à-vis the educator's learning objectives (Hägg and Kurczewska 2019; Neck and Corbett 2018) and 'heutagogy' indicates self-determined learning independent of the educator, where students' interests and motivations make up the focus area for new learning (Jones et al. 2014).

Emphasizing the necessity of those shifts, the EE literature forwards a 'pre-practice' figuration of the teachers and students, who are able to participate in EE as a particular kind of education practice. Hence, in order to stimulate access to entrepreneurial learning in a higher education context, teachers and students must (inter)act in particular ways, which typically contradicts conventional and more familiar teacher and student behaviour (Robinson et al. 2016). Still, the field acknowledges serious challenges related to practicing this ideal. Teachers may fall

back into conventional teacher roles (Jones, Penaluna, and Penaluna 2019) and students are not necessarily willing nor able to occupy the required learner directed stance and seize control of the learning process (Jones et al. 2014). Harima et al. (2021) suggest that students are trapped in stereotypical views of student roles. Through education, they have learnt to focus on how they are evaluated and graded and they continue to view themselves as passive knowledge recipients preferring or even demanding teacher directed learning. The literature also explains students' reluctance to engage and failure to learn in terms of their maturity level. Reporting from a course that employs effectuation as a method for educating entrepreneurship, Güntzel-Jensen and Robinson (2017) show examples of how student "noviceness", their disbelief in the authenticity of the entrepreneuring practice and the legitimacy of the teachers and the course hinder their engagement and learning. To counter such conflicts, researchers stress that the teacher facilitated learning arrangements must meet and match students at their level of development and seek to mature them during the course moving them from dependency-based learning towards autonomous learning (Jones, Penaluna, and Penaluna 2019; Hägg and Kurczewska 2019). This perspective underlines the importance of participant reorientation, adjustment and habituation to enable competent participation in EE practice. Consequently, connecting entrepreneuring and educational practice in experiential EE involves not only an initiation of participants into practicing entrepreneurship. It also involves an initiation of participants into practicing as competent entrepreneurship students and participants in EE practices.

Entrepreneurship education in a Practice Theory Perspective

Altogether, the literature on EE sheds important light on 'how to learn' entrepreneurially in institutionalized education and the requirements of entrepreneurial educators and students. Yet, despite the recognition that an integration of entrepreneurship and education practices is

fundamental to EE, there is a scarcity of studies, which attend to the connection of those practices and their practicing in local sites, employing alternative research methods (Gabrielsson et al. 2020, 1080). With this study, we aim to rejuvenate understandings of experiential EE, by directing a practice theory perspective on students' initiation, 'zooming in' on participation afforded and developed in a case of experiential EE, and 'zooming out' to understand the effects (Nicolini 2012). A practice theory perspective invites us to move beyond familiar dichotomies with the individual actor and his or her attitudes, behaviours and choices on the one hand and impersonal social structures on the other (Thompson, Verduijn, and Gartner 2020), viewing all social phenomena as rooted in nexus of practices (Nicolini 2012). Streams of literature recognize theories of practice as promising to entrepreneurship research (Thompson, Verduijn, and Gartner 2020; Champenois, Lefebvre, and Ronteau 2020; Steyaert 2007) including research in entrepreneurial learning (Thompson and Illes 2020). In education research, practice theoretical lenses are seen as suitable approaches for critical analyses, because they open the possibility of divergence and conflict between intended 'best practice' and emergent practices realized in the 'happeningness' of the education setting (Grootenboer, Edwards-Groves, and Choy 2017).

To operationalize practice theory in this study, we lean on Lave and Wenger's (1991) notion of LPP in CoPs. LPP represents a contrast to an acquisition view of learning as a cognitive, conceptual and individual matter. It highlights learning as relational and contextual, integral to changing participation in changing social practices. In that way, it emphasizes the interdependency of the agent and its socially and culturally structured world, activity, meaning, cognition and knowing (Lave and Wenger 1991, 50). Lave and Wenger coined the term to describe learning as the process in which newcomers become engaged within a CoP and gradually become able to act and be recognized as skilled participants in the social practices that are valued and socially

sustained in the CoP, developing identities as participants (Lave and Wenger 1991, 49-52). In that way, LPP is not in itself an educational model or teaching technique. It is an analytic viewpoint on learning, potentially applicable to all learning situations, even though Lave and Wenger focused on apprenticeships and non-school contexts (Lave and Wenger 1991, 98). Therefore, concepts of situated learning should not be applied to formal education settings uncritically (Boylan 2010; Anderson and McCune 2013). With a view from primary school, Boylan (2010) points towards a more complex notion of participation in mandatory schooling, since the CoP into which participants are initiated, may not be one they will remain in as practitioners. Anderson and McCune (2013) also emphasize how higher education involves a time-limited engagement in communities, which overlap or serve as preparation for participation in diverse future workplace communities. The situated learning perspective thus suggests that learning is when students increase their participation through the help of others (teachers and peers), in the situated practices of the classroom (Kemmis et al. 2014). Consequently, LPP in an education context means learning how to be a successful (or not successful) student and participant in education practices (Alkemeyer and Buschmann 2016).

We employ LPP as a ‘heuristic’ (Lea 2005) to access the intricacies of initiation into EE practices in higher education and to contribute to understanding how students are enabled to act and be recognized as competent participants. To do that, we follow Lave (2019), who questions the prevalent interpretation of a polar dichotomy between 'peripheral' and ‘central’ in LPP. Instead, she proposes the image of a ‘textured landscape of participation’, which does not necessarily end in an idealized 'full' participation (Lave 2019, 138). This view disrupts notions of LPP as a single process with a single direction and a single locus of change. Rather, we are sensitized to inquire

analytically into how practices 'hang together' and accumulate, and what effects this accumulation have (Nicolini 2017).

Methods

This study builds on ethnographic fieldwork. Ethnography involves a commitment to sustained, close-up observation and engagement with people and adopting an open-ended exploratory orientation to learn about the perspectives of the participants involved, paying close attention to what they say and do and the resources they employ in their activities over time (Hammersley and Atkinson 1995). Therefore, it is a research strategy well-suited to the study of practices (Champenois, Lefebvre, and Ronteau 2020) and learning processes (Walford 2008).

The research setting is a five-month entrepreneurship module, embedded in an interdisciplinary two-year postgraduate programme taught at the Arts faculty at a Scandinavian university. Each year, this programme accepts around 40 students from disciplines within the humanities and social sciences (Table 2). Theoretically and didactically, the module draws on understandings of entrepreneurship as a method (Sarasvathy and Venkataraman 2011), the individual- opportunity nexus (Shane and Venkataraman 2000), effectuation (Sarasvathy and Dew 2005), and an interpretation of how opportunities derive from an analytical stance towards everyday practices (Spinosa, Flores, and Dreyfus 1997). The students engage in a real entrepreneurship process from creation to execution of an entrepreneurial opportunity (Thrane et al. 2016).

During the time of fieldwork, two teachers were responsible for lectures and supervision. Teacher 1 was an experienced entrepreneurship educator brought in from the Business Department to teach in this particular module. Teacher 2 was a former student in the course and graduate of the programme. The two teachers assigned the students into work teams of five to six people with

an eye on educational diversity. Those teams worked through five assignments shown in Figure 1. The teachers introduced the assignments in lectures and the student teams commented on each other's work in formalized feedback sessions. The teams finalized the module with an exam-paper. As a compilation of all the assignments, they wrote reflectively about their entrepreneurial process and their learning, assisted by the course syllabus and other self-selected literature. The teachers assessed and graded these exams.

Data collection

The first author collected all data starting in January 2012. The main fieldwork lasted from September 2012 until March 2013 and was supplemented with additional visits in November 2013 and January 2014 to collect more data and to discuss tentative findings with key informants. An overview of the empirical material is outlined in Table 1.

In early 2012, the first author interviewed the teachers and the students who just completed the module. This work enabled her to understand, how the teachers intended the course to run and how the students experienced practicing and learning entrepreneurship. This triggered curiosity, and the first author sought access to observe in the module running from September 2012 to January 2013. Here, she closely followed Team Y. In lectures and in team meetings, she used observation to understand what the team did when working with assignments creating an entrepreneurial opportunity and executing it in collaboration with stakeholders. The choice of Team Y was arbitrary. In the first lecture, when the teacher divided students into teams, the first-author simply followed the person sitting next to her and asked permission to join the team as an observer. Hence, she had no prior knowledge of the participants, their experiences or qualifications.

Six students aged between 23 and 27 made up Team Y. Their prior education varied from business communication, marketing and management, to history of ideas and religion (Table 2). They expressed excitement about potential learning opportunities, yet none of them articulated learning expectations in terms of starting a business. They talked about how this module would make them 'face the world', improve their teamwork skills and ability to launch 'projects' in 'real life'. (Field notes, Lecture 1).

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Insert Table 1 about here

Insert Table 2 about her2

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Data analysis

No set analytical categories were identified prior to the fieldwork, even though the intention was to explore how students operate in EE through a practice theory lens. During the fieldwork, surprises and initial hunches were recorded in analytical memos. The focus thus developed as our theoretical and empirical understanding increased in a constantly iterative and comparative coding process parallel to data collection (Hammersley and Atkinson 1995).

We noticed that making sense of 'the process' and 'how to learn' was a constant theme throughout the course. Repeated module evaluations, teachers' explanations of the purpose of assignments and continuous team discussions about how to work out the assignments, all contributed to a pervasive meta-communication about the entrepreneurial process as an education practice. That is, something you participate in with the purpose of learning and becoming educated. It was at this point that we turned to LPP and started to engage analytically with these situations

as negotiations of forms of participation required to (not fail) to learn in this CoP (Lave and Wenger 1991).

Post-fieldwork, we interogated the empirical material for emerging patterns going back and forth between original fieldnotes, memoes of initial hunches, and litterature (Hammersley and Atkinson 1995). Consequently, as we noticed how various activities bundled into different versions of LPP, we started to think through a hierarchy moving from observable sayings and doings through practices as nexus(es) of those sayings and doings, to participation (Schatzki 2017). Hence, we began to grasp how meaning, purpose, rules and general understandings inherent to this practice arrangement, were continuously negotiated, emergent and manifested within three overarching domains characterizing three different modes of LPP.

Finally, we sought to establish relationships between the identified constellations of LPP. Revisiting the literature on EE, we recognized them as accepted requirements for teaching and learning entrepreneurially (c.f. Kyrö 2015; van Gelderen 2010) and we began to recognize the teachers' attempts to push the students into such ideal modes of participation. Yet, we were intrigued by how participants' enactments at times contradicted the ideals. Therefore, we started to digest how LPP involved practical coping (Nicolini 2012; Chia and Holt 2006) to make sense and resolve ambiguity when connecting entrepreneuring and education practices. Figure 2 illustrates the final data structure. Additional supporting evidence for these findings is shown in Table 3

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Insert Figure 2 about here

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Insert Table 3 about here

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Navigating the Landscape of Participation

At first glance, teacher-student interactions looked like any other teaching situation in a higher education institution. Lectures took place in large classrooms with the students sitting in rows facing the teacher and typically a PowerPoint presentation. However, in those lectures, the teachers and students not only discussed the curriculum readings about entrepreneurship. They also discussed 'how to learn entrepreneurially' with readings and PowerPoints explaining the overall course structure, logic, rules and purpose. Negotiation and struggle over the terms of engagement was ongoing throughout the course and revolved around three different constellations of LPP: compliance, autonomy and authenticity.

Compliance as Access to Learning

At first, compliance was the most noticeable mode of LPP in class. Discussions of how to learn entrepreneurially centered around the importance of trusting and following the process of the course and subjecting oneself to its logics and rules. The teachers introduced the students to the particular learning arrangement and the students worked to trust in the authority of their teachers and subject themselves to 'the process'.

Trusting the teachers and submitting to the process

Sayings like: 'trust in the process' and 'follow the process' were all assertions of how to access entrepreneurial learning. The teachers knew that for most students, learning through entrepreneurship was different from any other course they had been in. Therefore, they emphasized that it was a primary function of the lectures to 'legitimize the process' reassuring the students by explaining what they should do, and why they had to do it (Field notes, Conference Presentation). 'The process' offered a model of entrepreneurship and a tentative outline for how and when the students were supposed to engage in various activities, learn about and employ specific tools

related to creating and enacting entrepreneurial opportunities. ‘The process’ also gained material presence as the syllabus included a small book, referred to in lectures as ‘the process book’. It described the various stages of the model, the supportive theoretical framework, and the learning purpose of assignments. Backed by the process book, the teachers clarified the logics of the course and called for the students’ acceptance of ‘the process’ as an unconventional yet academically accountable and trustworthy learning opportunity.

Moreover, the students were told to follow a set of formal rules. A rule of ‘no make belief’ involved the requirement of real entrepreneurial practice and no pretense. What the students said they would do, they should actually try to do. Another rule told the students not to decide on the character of their entrepreneurship early in the process. Instead, the teams should learn entrepreneurially with the process stages and work sincerely with assignments. Attempts to jump to conclusions and make it seem as if they were developed through the process flow were regarded as ‘cheating’ and the teachers warned the students of what they called ‘drawer ideas’ and ‘backwards unravelling’. In a lecture, the teacher explained:

> It is no good if you keep a project in the drawer and then take it out. Then it [the process] turns into a backwards unravelling and that is not good. At some point, we [the teachers] will discover it. It is actually quite easy to see. And it is no fun for you (Teacher, Field notes, Lecture III).

In that way, the teachers sought to monitor ‘how’ students learned by conditioning LPP (Lave and Wenger 1991) and recognition implied compliance with some (pre)established orders of suitable behavior (Alkemeyer and Buschmann 2016).

The students listened to the teachers’ instructions and used the process book as an ‘encyclopedia’ to consult for information on theory or when in doubt of the purpose of

assignments. The following interaction is from a meeting, where Team Y worked to complete an assignment by discussing and answering a range of questions posed by faculty:[1]

Rose: Why are they [the teachers] asking all of these questions? Can't we just skip them and move on to something more important?

Julie: (Reading the process book). In the example in the book, they actually skipped a question.

William: We cannot just skip a question. I mean, they are there for a reason, so we have to go along with it. The questions are there to make you think about things, so we cannot just skip a question even though they seem dumb. I believe it is important to learn in the process. At least I would like to do that. Let's continue just for a little while. There are only a few questions left.

Emma: But the next question is about Abell's model[2] and how it can be applied to possible solutions. We have not even talked about solutions yet.

Rose: I am so ready to talk solutions.[3] It really makes me uneasy to keep opening up. All this talking is nonsense. I really don't get it. What is it supposed to do?

William: Really, I don't think we should be talking about solutions before we are ready. We should follow the process. […]. If you are thinking about solutions now Rose, then please keep them to yourself. I would like to be allowed to just be in the process and learn what I can from that (Field notes, Teamwork, Team Y).

This interaction exemplifies a conflict typical of the students' negotiations about how to participate, when they did not understand the immediate purpose of the activities imposed on them. Some showed concern with this lack of understanding and suggested skipping assignments, doing things their own way to solve this uncertainty. However, the majority of Team Y members preferred to 'be in' or 'follow the process,' doing what they were told to do, when they were told to do it. They worked to suspend uncertainties by upholding trust and voluntarily subject

[1] The questions were meant to inspire practices of "cross-appropriation" and "reconfiguration" following the work of Spinosa, Flores and Dreyfuss (1997). For example: "Write down examples of practices that you consider to be good" "Which of these practices could be fruitful in your work?" "How would these practices change the lives of people you address with your work?"

[2] Reference is made to Derek F. Abell's "Three vector model" which was introduced as a project development tool in the process book. Originally published in Abell, D.F. (1980) *Defining the business: the starting point of strategic planning*. Prentice-Hall, Englewood Cliffs, N.J.

[3] "Solutions" to the problems that the team had identified in their everyday lives (see Figure 1)

themselves to the authority of the process and the teachers, censoring other team member's behaviours. In the final exam paper, Team Y presented this form of participation in the following way:

> (In this module) we accepted to give up our normal patterns of behaviour in a working process and take on this new thinking in order to learn the most. (Exam, Team Y)

The students learnt that to 'learn the most', they had to submit themselves to 'the process' and 'give up' on the ways they would normally behave and be. They showed the teachers that they accepted this compliance and that they were open to possible transformations aided by the process. In that way, compliance contributed to institute the entrepreneurial process as an educational practice i.e. something you do with the purpose of learning.

Effects: constituting entrepreneuring as education practice confirming hierarchical relations

The students were enabled to take part in EE practices by trusting the teachers and the process, abiding by the rules and the 'how to learn' logics of the course. Stressing compliant participation, students and teachers collaboratively conjured 'the process' as a legitimate pre-structured arrangement that students should enter and adhere to in order to learn entrepreneurially and be recognized as competent participants (Alkemeyer and Buschmann 2016). Hence, 'the process' and its practices of entrepreneuring were made intelligible as education practice. Simultaneously, student participants were figured in terms of a lack (Biesta 2010), which was to be filled through the intervention of teacher supervision, reading the curriculum, following course rules, working with assignments, etc. Compliant participation thus (re)produced hierarchical social arrangements in class between teachers as knowing (old-timers) and students as unknowing (newcomers) (Lave and Wenger 1991). Since it was regarded a condition for learning that students follow rules and

subject themselves to specific actions, it became necessary to monitor the appropriate performance of those actions. Teachers monitored students and the students censored each other.

Autonomy as Access to Learning

The students could not leave everything to 'the process'. The teachers also expected them to engage in a self-determined way for purposes they themselves decided on. We call this form of LPP 'autonomy'. Scholarship emphasizes autonomy as a particular entrepreneurial attribute (Gibb 1987) and developing student capacity for autonomous action has been put forward as the ultimate aim of EE (van Gelderen 2010). In that way, autonomy as LPP is not a strange discovery in experiential EE. Yet, our analysis suggests that the practice of autonomy was ambiguous and contested, since participation recognized by teachers not necessarily likened the autonomy the students enacted, when they felt that they took ownership of 'the process' or even resisted 'the process.' Below we elaborate on this.

Acting self-determinately

The teachers expressed concern that the students were too occupied with what the teachers wanted them to do. In an interview, one of them said:

> The students always try to figure out: What do they want? Where are we going with this? What is the goal? […] What do *they* want? […]. Instead of what do *I* want? What would *I* like to learn? What am *I* interested in here? (Interview, Teacher)

The other teacher said:

> Sometimes I suspect that the students believe that if they just follow the process, learning happens automatically. But, if they only follow the rules and do as the teacher says, they don't learn anything. (Field notes, Teachers' meeting)

Especially students' participation in the feedback-sessions puzzled the teachers. It seemed to them as if the students were not able to understand how to take advantage of these sessions to grow their projects and learn. In one session, members of Team Y expressed doubts about what they were supposed to do to realize the learning potentials of the situation. They asked the instructor for advice. He answered:

> I am not an expert. I am only here to support the process. It is you, who must create this space and find out how to use it. You have to learn it yourselves from within. You have to dare be in it. Dare throw yourself into it and dare to be in the process with the expectation that it will help you proceed. (Field notes, Feedback session II, Team Y)

In accordance with EE scholarship, the teachers took it upon themselves to act as facilitators rather than authoritative knowledge transmitters (Neck and Corbett 2018). In that role, they were not able to explain to the students exactly how they could capitalize on their participation. Since EE should train the students to pursue their own opportunities (Thrane et al. 2016), access to learning was associated with the students' attitudes to dare, grasp, direct and exploit the learning arrangement free from teacher directions. Hence, the students should act out the learner orientation that this experiential learning model requires, showing responsibility towards their own learning by acting self-determinately when striving to define and realize personal (learning) goals (van Gelderen 2010; Kyrö 2015).

Taking ownership

The students started out 'the process' by identifying their means (Sarasvathy and Dew 2005) and analyzing problems in their everyday life, that they would like to solve (Spinosa, Flores, and Dreyfus 1997). In Team Y, working with self-chosen problems, gave them a thrilling sense of freedom and self-dependence, as voiced by a member: 'It is just so cool to finally be allowed to work with what you want' (Fieldnotes, Teamwork, Team Y). As the module progressed, the team

decided to stop working on assignments. In an interview just after submitting the final exam paper, one of them explained:

> Somebody, in the team suggested that we skipped the school assignments. It was only when we took such ownership over the process that we started to have an actual process (Interview, William, Team Y).

When team members made the active choice to ignore the 'school assignments' and deliberately disengage from school practice, they experienced improved collaboration and found themselves in an 'actual process' as self-determined actors. Others supported this statement:

> We stopped thinking creatively; well we stopped thinking at all because we followed the assignments. When we stopped [working on them], well then we actually moved forward. I mean, we finally started thinking ourselves. (Interview, Emma, Team Y)

Also in other teams, the sense of 'ownership' and being in control of 'the process' was seen as inconsistent with compliantly solving assignments. Yet, a rumor started going around about a feedback session, where a teacher reprimanded a team for not having advanced far enough in 'the process'. In an interview, a student explained this incident:

> The teacher scolded us and said it was embarrassing. The teacher was angry because we were not where we were supposed to be in the process. Yet, all this time we were told that we were allowed to iterate … so we thought: "Alright it will work out fine. We do it our way." But the teacher suddenly says that we should have made these assignments and it was just sloppy what we had done. (Interview, Freya, Team Z)

The students reported on experiences of contradiction between the requirement of autonomous participation and the required compliance. On the other hand, the teachers interpreted the 'we do it our way' withdrawal from schoolwork as sloppiness or cheating. In an interview, one of them said:

> You are not rewarded [with a high grade] if we see through the exam paper, that the project was run independently on the side. If for example all the assignments are not handed in or the log book is half a page with bullet points, […]. Again 'the process'. If I cannot see the process clearly as an educator, then it may be what we call 'drawer ideas' […] and two parallel lives right, like 'we do this [for school], but then we run our own thing on the side, because the entrepreneur is a person who just acts, right'. (Interview, Teacher).

Since the students were to learn through 'the process', it became the job of the teachers to secure that this was what actually happened. Therefore, when evaluating student participation, the teachers looked for transparency in the students' presentations to discover 'drawer ideas' and 'parallel lives' where the students compliantly followed the course, but autonomously did the entrepreneurship. Hence, they were alert to signs that students did not connect education and entrepreneuring practices.

After evaluating and grading the exam papers, one of the teachers explained that the students who received high grades somehow all had 'accepted the course format'. 'They may have been skeptical at first, but they changed their attitude to "how can we use this"' (Conversation, Teacher). In that way, the evaluation of students' performances was closely connected to how the students complied to pre-figured practices, yet personalized them, as they were able to make sense of how to use and perform them self-determinately. Therefore, we argue that rather than a property of individuals and a pre-condition for accessing entrepreneurial learning as indicated by the literature (van Gelderen 2010; Kyrö 2015), autonomous participation is a result of newcomers' initiation and changing participation in the social practices, reflecting a mastery of rules, meanings, values, language and skill (Lave and Wenger 1991). Hence, when recognized by the teachers, legitimate autonomous participation was an expression of 'practical understanding' (Schatzki 2012) as students were enabled to take part and carry out self-directed actions through sanctioned doings and sayings within the CoP (Lave and Wenger 1991).

However, the students responded that they felt constrained by the school activities, which to them confirmed an asymmetrical teacher/student power structure. While they in the beginning of the process expressed trust in the teachers' expertise, over time they increasingly voiced skepticism. Amongst themselves, they discussed the 'arrogance' of the teachers who presented 'the process' as the only valid interpretation of entrepreneurship and would not listen to any critiques of 'their methods', which made it comparable to 'religious activities and mantras' and in essence 'un-academic' (Fieldnotes, Lectures III and VII; Observations, student common room).

Effects: negotiating participation and disconnecting practices

The requirement of autonomy involved an increasing sense of disconnection between education and entrepreneuring practices. Amongst the students, autonomy as LPP was associated with doing entrepreneuring and the freedom to choose one's own actions. To act entrepreneurially, they prioritized the activities they associated with 'entrepreneuring' compared to activities they associated with 'school'. Yet, the teachers interpreted that as a threat to the students' entrepreneurial learning and felt increasing need to support the students by monitoring how they connected practices of education and entrepreneuring. In their efforts, the teachers therefore (unintentionally) became more controlling in ways of pushing students towards compliance. The students expressed frustration with the teachers' control and power over them as students. Hence, autonomous participation was riddled with tension related to how autonomy could and should be practiced to be recognized as access to learning and struggles resulted in a paradox. The students complained about teachers' coercion, while the teachers lamented how the students did not take responsibility for themselves and their own learning.

Authenticity as Access to Learning

Associated with the ideals of autonomy and encapsulated by the rule of 'no make belief,' authentic participation manifested in two ways. First, practicing 'real' entrepreneurship was a requirement in this module. Yet, authenticity as LPP involved more than authentic practices of entrepreneuring. The teachers clarified how the students should sincerely want something from their intervention in the world. All in accordance with scholarship that emphasizes how EE, to increase the depth and intensity of learning, should be driven by learners' passions (Kyrö 2015; Thrane et al. 2016).

Doing entrepreneurship

From the start, the teachers explicitly emphasized the importance of 'intervening in the world', which required that students engaged with people outside the classroom to create 'real value' solving common anomalies (Spinosa, Flores, and Dreyfus 1997). In fact, the teachers turned the act of calling up potential stakeholders into an event in a lecture, to 'push' students into action (Field notes, Lecture VI). To the students, the 'no make believe' and the focus on 'doing' as opposed to 'theorizing' was a key definition of entrepreneurship and the entrepreneur:

> Entrepreneurship. It is not something we are playing. It is something we are doing. We cannot just say that we do it. We have to actually do it. I think that is great, because that is really what entrepreneurship is about. You are not an entrepreneur before you have done something (Interview, Violet, Team Z)

They recognized that entrepreneurial learning was tied to doing actual entrepreneurship. However, in the final lecture, when answering questions about the exam, the teacher told the students that they should start acting out their entrepreneurship before writing the final report. This led to a discussion about authentic practice:

Student 1: Will it not just be all rubbish when we have to do the project before the exam?
Teacher: You have a deadline. The project cannot stall and go on forever.
Student 2: But all the way through [this module] you have told us to be ambitious with the projects. The way we are pressured now does not really fit that level of ambition.
Teacher: You still have until January.
Student 2: But real life entrepreneurs do not carry out projects in just one and a half month!
Teacher: No, then they downscale so they can still see themselves in the project; and they do what can be done. You must intervene in the world and show how this intervention has somehow solved the anomaly.
Student 3: Again, are we really supposed to have time to do the intervention before submitting the exam report?
Teacher: Yes. It is in the intervention that you learn. You learn 200%.

Due to a sense of time pressure, students reacted against the teacher's call that to learn, they had to enact their projects before handing in the exam. The teacher stressed that entrepreneuring outside the school setting was important to excel in the education. However, the students were skeptical about their opportunities to live out this logic and regarded the exam deadline as a hindrance to doing ambitious projects as 'real entrepreneurs'. When told to subject their entrepreneuring to conditions of the course and thus explicitly turning it into an education practice, students started questioning the authenticity of the activity and implicitly their learning opportunities. Towards the end of the semester, we thus see a heightened uncertainty about understanding 'the process' in terms of education and a sense of disconnection between practices interpreted as education and entrepreneurship.

Sincere investment of self

The teachers ruled that an entrepreneurship process, which involved a sincere investment of self, was better to 'learn through'. As a teacher explained to Team Y:

> You have only intervened in the world and the world has intervened in you, the day that you realize this is not just a school project. (Field notes, Supervision II, Team Y)

In the last lecture, to trigger the students' ambitions, the teacher also asked them:

> Think about it. How can you ask others to commit and contribute to your school project? But is it really just a school project? (Field notes, Lecture VII)

The distinction between 'school projects' and 'entrepreneurial projects' became prominent when negotiating participation as it symbolized a difference in ambition, quality and moral. When it came to learning possibilities, 'school projects' were inferior. The teachers told the students to act out projects driven by passion. Even though the students were obliged to do entrepreneurship as part of a mandatory module, to be a proper entrepreneurial learning opportunity, the project should stand as the result of a desire to pursue a problem beyond the course and beyond being a student. This suggests that the authenticity of entrepreneuring and the possibility to access entrepreneurial learning granted by this authenticity was defined against a school practice, which consequently was deemed inauthentic.

The students acknowledged that access to entrepreneurial learning was conditioned by sincere self-investment.

> What really puts pressure on you is that everything must be felt. You have to be passionate about everything. There is nothing you can just learn!
> (Field notes, Observations Student Common Room after lecture VI)

They accepted a mode of participation where 'everything must be felt' and the importance of showing this engagement for others to recognize. Preparing the first assignments, Team Y engaged in lengthy discussions about their personal strengths and weaknesses, 'who they were, what they knew and who they knew' (Sarasvathy and Dew 2005), working towards something all could 'feel in the guts'. However, this changed towards the end of the semester.

> Constantly you have to go with your passions. But, sometime around November, a silent taboo emerged: "If anybody cannot agree now, then they just swallow it up, since we no longer have time nor energy to discuss and change". (Interview, Emma, Team Y)

As explained above, team members monitored each other in terms of 'following the process' to learn. This took another turn, when in order to be ready for the exam, they started to make each other compromise in loyalty to the team. Hence, authenticity emerged as an 'as if' performance and coherent team act (Frederiksen and Berglund 2020). This heightened the uncertainty regarding access to learning and ambiguity regarding whom one is and is required to be when participating and learning entrepreneurially. In the exam paper, Team Y reflected on this:

> Are we a team with a school project or are we an entrepreneurial project team? Towards stakeholders, we wanted to come across as a project team, but our unwillingness to upscale the project, pushed us in the direction of a school project. […]. We have not been able to take this intervention beyond the course. We intervened due to a school request and we designed our intervention so that it ceases with the course. As individuals, we have not been able to make a sufficient buy-in to our team or into our project so that we could act as entrepreneurs (Exam, Team Y)

The feeling of not being able to make 'sufficient buy-in' to the team and to the project meant that Team Y experienced a lack of accomplishment and felt they had to back down from their entrepreneurial learning ambitions. Hence, they sensed that they failed to make the most out of this learning opportunity due to the lack of sincere self-investments. The failure was explained by the inability to escape a 'school project' and student participation. A member of another team expressed this in terms of experienced identity conflict fostered by practices in this setting:

> We were quite frustrated about it all. Are we entrepreneurs or are we students? I mean the "no make believe" sort of suggests that we are entrepreneurs. But, it all ends with an exam and a deadline and then we are students. How do we coordinate these two? I believe around mid-December, we agreed that we were students in this process. We were not entrepreneurs (Interview, Helen, Team T).

The student associated different identities with different practices and ends. Hence, even though the experiential learning arrangement sought to connect entrepreneuring and education practices, the students still disconnected them. As shown above, they experienced that it was necessary to choose between practices and their corresponding purposes and actor identifications that seemed

mutually exclusive in the practice arrangement. Working towards an exam deadline made sense as an education practice, which unavoidably made them student actors through their engagement, even though they learnt in class, that this was not attractive. Yet, in the end there was no escaping the school project and as an effect no acting as 'real entrepreneurs', which led to a sense of failure and a missed learning opportunity.

Effects: Disconnecting practices and education as fictive entrepreneurship

Even though the teachers encouraged authenticity as LPP, students experienced how recognition of authentic participation increasingly depended on inauthentic performance. Recognition of authenticity was closely connected to the students' abilities to connect practices of education and entrepreneuring in a transparent manner avoiding 'parallel lives'. However, the students found it difficult to practice this connection. Instead, the ongoing negotiation of authenticity as LPP resulted in experiences of opposition between entrepreneurship and education. Since authentic participation was associated with doing 'real entrepreneurship' as 'real entrepreneurs', a 'school project' primarily intelligible as education was infested with inauthenticity and deemed inferior as learning opportunity. Consequently, a dilemma arose for the students around the telos of practice. That is, whether they engaged for the purpose of education or for the purpose of passionately solving an anomaly and creating value for oneself and others. Hence, practice intelligibility became an issue. Ultimately, in what CoP were the students authentic legitimate peripheral participants? The students experienced that they had to choose between practices, distancing themselves from school when acting as entrepreneurs and 'succumbing' to being recognized as students when prioritizing school activities. Since acting as a student in the process was projected less attractive, the inability to escape student subjectivation when practicing entrepreneuring as education, was eventually associated with failure.

Initiating Students into Practices of Entrepreneurship (and) Education – a Discussion

In this study, we found that the initiation of students into EE practices involved multiple and even contradictory modes of participation. We believe our findings show the relevance of practice theory for studies in higher education and allow us to make distinct contributions to the EE literature, theorizing in ways alternative to individual agent oriented explanations, why ideals of connecting entrepreneuring and education practice can create tension and disconnection. In this section, we outline these contributions. Finally, we reflect on the limitations of the study as well as pathways to future research.

A Complex Landscape of Participation

EE scholarship acknowledges that connecting practices of education and entrepreneuring creates tension (Neck and Corbett 2018; Günzel-Jensen and Robinson 2017). Typically this is explained as an outcome of participants' acting as 'students' rather than 'entrepreneurial agents' (Harima, Kroczak, and Repnik 2021; Robinson et al. 2016). Hence, the literature forwards a view of participants as entities with particular dispositions that may or may not enable them to take part in purposeful EE activities. The ongoing discussion on how to balance between pedagogy, andragogy or heutagogy in EE, suggests that the enactment of proper teaching practice may work positively to mature the students and resolve challenges related to their participation (Hägg and Kurczewska 2019; Jones, Penaluna, and Penaluna 2019).

With this study, we contribute to understanding with a practice theory perspective. In this view, learning is not a distinct activity, but an ongoing process inherent to any practice. Consequently, teaching is neither necessary nor sufficient to produce learning (Lave 2019, 96) and students cannot be guided instrumentally as entities in desired directions by particular practice arrangements. That is because practices do not determine individual behavior, but are entered into,

developed and changed in and through social relationships in time and space (Grootenboer, Edwards-Groves, and Choy 2017). Neither are students' abilities to take part viewed as individual dispositions separate from the settings in which they act (Alkemeyer and Buschmann 2016). Following this, agent identities and their behavioural strategies as 'students' or 'entrepreneurial agents' are not pre-practically given, but co-constructed relationally through an engagement in practices in social and institutional arrangements (Chia and Holt 2006; Lave 2019). Therefore, when we in our study recognize tension, we suggest that this is an effect of practices emerging from the modes of LPP afforded in the learning arrangement. An analytical focus on practices made it possible to capture how the situational enactment of EE in our case involved a landscape of multiple and also contradictory practices of participation involving trusting and resisting, engaging sincerely and performing sincerity, submitting to the process and acting self-directed. As a summary of our findings, Figure 3 maps this landscape and shows how acknowledged forms of LPP were practiced in this particular course.

…….

Insert Figure 3 about here

……

We inductively derived at compliance, autonomy and authenticity as different modes of LPP. Still, we recognized these concepts in the EE literature as accepted understandings of how entrepreneurial learning can be accessed in higher education. Compliance is reflected in the recommendations of settings particularly organized for entrepreneurial learning and the division between a teacher controlled procedure 'how to learn' and a student controlled content 'what to learn' (Thrane et al. 2016; Jones, Penaluna, and Penaluna 2019). Autonomy is a hallmark of experiential EE and linked to entrepreneurial emergence as students take responsibility and the

associated risks about the success or failure of their projects, yet are freed in the process to pursue their own learning needs and desires (Johannisson 2016; Kyrö 2015). Additionally, we recognize authenticity in the literature, which emphasizes students' actual engagement in entrepreneuring practices and a necessary emotional exposure (Pittaway and Cope 2007). However, even though the three modes of LPP make sense one by one and are forwarded as 'best practice' in EE, we show how their accumulation created a complex landscape of interconnected yet contradictory practices that students had navigate to be able to act and be recognized as competent EE participants (Figure 3). This suggests a dynamic and nonlinear conception of LPP that involves multiple positions and conflicting practices. Our study thus confirms that LPP is not necessarily a matter of peaceful transmission and assimilation, but a conflictual process of negotiation and struggle over the terms of engagement and premises for participation (Lave and Packer 2008), which in our case resulted in students complaining about teacher coercion, while the teachers lamented students' lack of self-dependency and responsibility. Additionally, we contribute to the growing stream of literature that seeks to understand entrepreneurship in terms of practices and their relations (Thompson, Verduijn, and Gartner 2020; Champenois, Lefebvre, and Ronteau 2020), showing the fruitfulness of practice theory in the field of EE, as it enables necessary reflection on important taken-for-granted assumptions (Fayolle 2013).

Legitimate Peripheral Participation as Practical Coping

Re-specifying EE in terms of different modes of LPP, practices and their relations made us realize, how participants were actually acting in and enacting a paradox. Every entrepreneurial project was initiated as part of a mandatory module and by entrepreneurial teams put together in and by the education setting. Still, the project was never to be recognized as a 'school project'. The students were asked to submit themselves to the process and act compliantly to learn. However, if they only

did what the teachers told them to, they would not learn properly. Additionally, the students' understandings of authentic participation were increasingly challenged. 'School projects' and participation as 'students' were not recognized as authentic, and when ruled, authenticity gave way to performance (Frederiksen and Berglund 2020).

With this realization, we suggest that students trusting teachers' authority, resisting school related obligations or performing sincerity (Figure 3) all are intelligible as LPP practices, even though they confuse the teachers and in their view hamper entrepreneurial learning. We find that they emerge as forms of practical coping to make sense and enable participation as participants learn to direct, adjust and signal their doings and sayings to the requirements of specific contexts and relations (Chia and Holt 2006; Alkemeyer and Buschmann 2016), and simultaneously produce and reproduce those contexts and relations (Lave 2019).

Practical coping describes meaningful non-deliberate and never completely predictable responses to situations that are made available to subjects by the way that the social world is organized (Chia and Holt 2006). Practices are social, set in motion by processes of intelligibility and given some coherence and identity by their inherent teleological nature (Nicolini 2012, 171). However, telos is never self-evident. It is partly given and partly emergent in practice (Nicolini 2017). Hence, the meaning of an act is established in the happeningness in and of the practical context in which it appears and not through some form of disengaged and pre-practice interpretation by an individual actor consciously weighing costs and benefits (Grootenboer, Edwards-Groves, and Choy 2017). This also means that what makes sense for participants to do is not always the same as what is specified by a set of explicit rules, norms or beliefs, for example about how to learn entrepreneurially (Nicolini 2012, 163). Due to their emergent nature, practices can only be prefigured in educational practice arrangements in the sense

that practitioners have some ideas of the form, purpose and outcomes of practice. They can never be predetermined (Grootenboer, Edwards-Groves, and Choy 2017). They develop in the interaction and collaboration of participants as they 'socialize' each other into practices and position one another in them (Alkemeyer and Buschmann 2016). In that way, we can better grasp the initiation of students into EE practices and how they are enabled to act and be recognized as competent participants. Both students and teachers draw on and perform compliance, autonomy and authenticity as modes of LPP, yet, they must also find ways to cope with contradictions. Consequently, those modes of LPP afforded in the learning arrangement are resources to both connect and disconnect education and entrepreneuring practices. Hence, we suggest that the tensions experienced by participants in our study, closely relates to the emergent subjective and intersubjective interpretation of the why, how and who of the ongoing practice and the multiplicity of different realities created in and through the landscape of participation.

Learning through entrepreneurship: connecting or disconnecting practices

Pittaway and Cope (2007, 227) argue that an experiential design in EE should enable students to step outside their reality as students and become enveloped in a new reality temporarily taking on an entrepreneurial 'persona'. Following this view, the aspired connection of different realities and their oppositional identities and practices is associated with a moving away from the messiness of practicing, constituting EE as a neutral realm of reflection and detachment where decontextualized knowledge can be attained (Hägg and Kurczewska 2016; Warhuus, Blenker, and Elmholdt 2018). We suggest that EE connecting practices of entrepreneuring and education can never be regarded as a neutral setting. Following situated learning theory, EE is an intersection of multiple overlapping CoPs. Yet, they are not materialized as physical spaces to look 'for', e.g. inside and outside the university. Rather, they are socially constructed realms of interpretation to look

'through' (Lave 2019). Those realms guide understanding of what is going on. They influence expectations of practices and participants and provide for normative criteria of appropriate participation (Alkemeyer and Buschmann 2016).

What may be particular to EE is how those intersecting CoPs are never fully settled and defined. We found that students started an initiation into EE by submitting to new rules for participation defined in opposition to conventional learning arrangements. Still, as a mode of participation compliance constituted entrepreneuring as an education practice and participants as teachers and students in a hierarchical relationship as in conventional education. While education was the frame through which practicing compliance came to make sense to the participants, autonomy made 'the process' intelligible as an entrepreneuring practice. The students experienced autonomy as a mode of LPP, when they broke free from confining rules of education as self-determined entrepreneurs. To complicate matters further, the students understood that they were not 'really' initiated into an entrepreneurship CoP as they were subjecting their entrepreneuring to an exam and recognized by the teachers when performing pre-figured EE practices in a self-determined way. Authenticity as a mode of LPP made 'the process' intelligible as either school or entrepreneurship and participants intelligible as either students practicing inauthentic school projects or (potential) entrepreneurial agents practicing authentic entrepreneurial projects. In that way, the multiplicity and partiality of the involved CoPs and the complexity of LPP hedged the interpretation of action, as it could be unclear which CoP was or should be instanced in the practice. Therefore, the participants needed to clearly signal, what interpretive realm should be activated to understand their doings and sayings. This can explain the students' explicit disconnection of practices as *either* entrepreneuring or education and the experiences of tension related to the ambition of actually connecting them. To act intelligibly as competent practitioners in the eyes of

others and themselves, the students had to show attributes and quality of their participation in terms of a performed attitude: compliance, autonomy and authenticity. The attitude depended on normative expectations and aesthetic criteria of style to make practices recognizable in terms of education or entrepreneuring and practitioners as students or entrepreneurial agents (Alkemeyer and Buschmann 2016). Consequently, we contribute to the literature on situated learning by highlighting a 'normative aesthetics' in the forms of LPP afforded in a higher education context.

In our study, the students found they were offered what seemed a self-dependent choice between irreconcilable participatory agencies. Yet, in the end, they realized that choice was illusory. There was no escaping being recognized as a student (by self and others) when practicing entrepreneuring in education with the purpose of learning and passing an exam. This indicates that becoming recognizable as an entrepreneurial learner and competent practitioner in experiential EE is an ambiguous undertaking with a high risk of disappointment for students as well as teachers. Our study thus contributes to EE theory and practice suggesting how tensions may be inherent to recognized learning arrangements. Indeed, ambiguities in experiential learning arrangements are reported also outside the field of entrepreneurship (cf. Iszatt-White, Kempster, and Carroll 2017; Lier 2007). However, it may be particularly prevalent in EE where figurations of 'the entrepreneur' as an autonomous and self-dependent individual are strongly reflected in theorizations of how to access entrepreneurial learning and the pre-practice figurations of the competent entrepreneurial student (van Gelderen 2010; Jones 2014). Therefore, we must be better at understanding the situated sociocultural production of learning, learners and things to be learnt in practice and how this actually compares to or are effects of those pre-figurations portrayed in the literature.

Limitations and Pathways for Future Studies

The study raises some intriguing questions for future research, about how students can access learning through entrepreneuring in higher education. However, since our study presents findings from a single case, it is problematic to extend them to a larger discussion. We may mitigate this by emphasizing how the research setting was informed by generally accepted assumptions in EE scholarship. Yet, we also emphasize that practice studies in EE are important to highlight the 'happeningness' of education (Grootenboer, Edwards-Groves, and Choy 2017) even though they are exposed to the 'risks of localism' (Nicolini 2017, 15). Hence, we provide resources that EE educators can use to compare, reflect, and make sense of their own situations and practices. Our findings are based on research in a mandatory module in postgraduate education for non-business students. That students have not explicitly self-selected into the course is likely to have affected uncertainty about participation, the experiences of coercion as well as the definitions of entrepreneurship and understandings of entrepreneurial practice. A study of LPP in elective modules would be suitable to understand the meaning of self-selection as well as the production of educational and entrepreneuring practices and communities. Future research could also complement this study's general outlook on participation patterns with in-depth studies sensitive to individual participants and their learning trajectories.

Conclusion

With this study, we provide a detailed investigation of how students are initiated into EE practices in a case of postgraduate EE for non-business students. Employing a practice theory perspective (Lave and Wenger 1991), we are able to shed new light onto well-known discussions in EE research about the challenges of introducing entrepreneuring practices in institutionalized

education and shifting from a familiar teaching-oriented educational practice towards a learning-oriented setup.

We show how access to learning through entrepreneurship was practiced in three forms of LPP: compliance, autonomy, and authenticity. The effects in this case, was a growing understanding amongst the students of a disconnect between practices intelligible as entrepreneuring and practices intelligible as education. They experienced a sense of inability to 'escape' student behaviour due to teacher control and demand for compliance, while teachers lamenting this inability sought to remedy it through intensified supervision and control.

As good intentions and acknowledged theory about entrepreneurship and entrepreneurial learning are translated into education practices at local sites, things happen which influence students' opportunities to take part in ways that cannot easily be foreseen. To develop as a legitimate field of research and practice, EE could therefore benefit from more studies of the processes, practices and telos of participants and not alone the anticipated outcomes of education (Fayolle, Verzat, and Wapshott 2016; Gabrielsson et al. 2020). Specifically, EE research should engage critically with those figurations of the entrepreneurial learner endorsed as conditions for entrepreneurial learning. Hence, we call for a stronger focus on EE as social practices within higher education to understand how practice arrangements actually generate participation opportunities and practical coping, and again how learning arrangements develop and change as participants engage in the teaching and learning practices (Grootenboer, Edwards-Groves, and Choy 2017). We trust this will create a better understanding not only of EE as a specific educational arrangement, but also of how to create effective learning practices that support entrepreneurial learning in higher education.

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TABLE 1: Overview of the data-material

Data type	Sources	Data format	Length
Observation	Classroom (38 hrs) Team work (40 hrs.) Student common room (5 hrs.) Teacher's meetings (+20 hrs) Conferences (+10 hrs.)	Field notes jotted down during the event and later written up as electronic documents	approx. 400 pages
Formal interviews	14 students (2011 class) (90-120 min.) 12 students (2012 class) (90-120 min.) 2 module educators (60-90 min.) 1 teacher from programme (60 min.)	Digital sound recordings and transcriptions	approx. 700 pages
Documents	45 student assignments of 2 pages 9 exam papers of approx. 60 pages WIKI uploads Course description and syllabus Field diary and memo's	Printed and electronic documents	+1000 pages

FIGURE 1: The structure of the five assignments

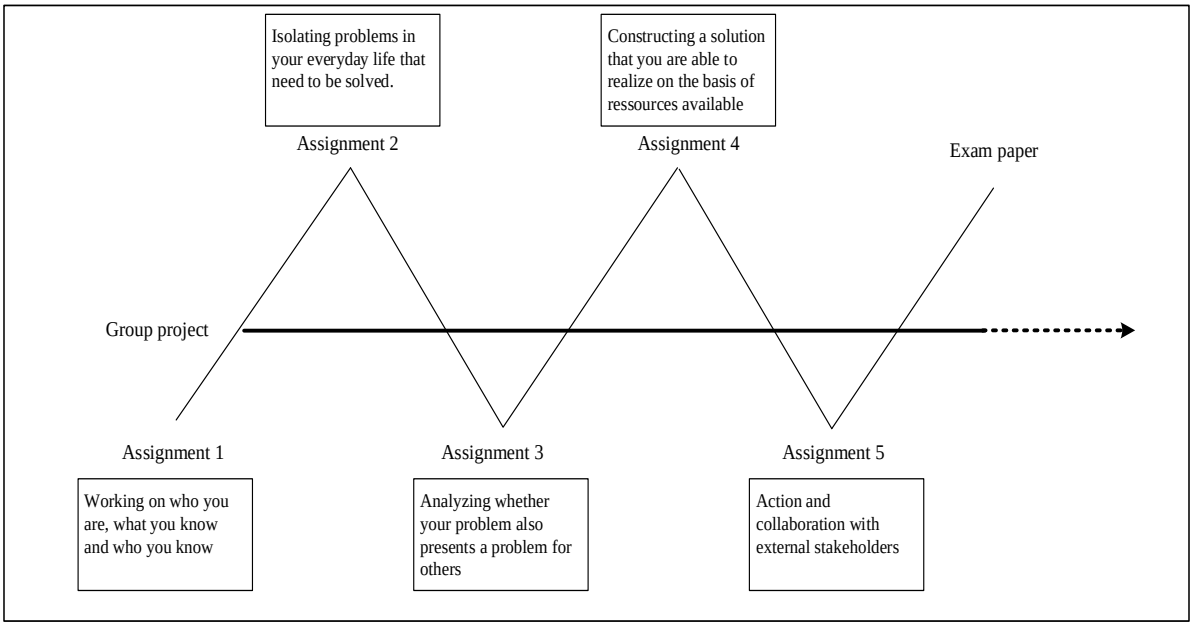


TABLE 2. Details of interview data 2012-2014

Interviewee	2012	2013	2014	Total
Student Eva, BA Archaeology	1			
Student Jacob, BA Sport science	1			
Student Joe, BA Archaeology	1			
Student Moe, BA Dance	1			
Student Miriam, BA Archaeology	1			
Student Sue, BA Business	1			
Student Carla, BA Philosophy	1			
Student Robert, BA Business	1			
Student Flynn, BA History	1			
Student Thomas, BA Philosophy	1			
Student Carrie, BA Aesthetics and culture	1			
Student Bill, BA History	1			
Student Maya, BA Business	1			
Student Amy, BA Music	1			
Team Y Amanda, BA History of Ideas		2		
Team Y William, BA History of Ideas		2		
Team Y Corina, BA Business		1		
Team Y Emma, BA Business communication		1		
Team Y Rose, BA Religion		1		
Team Y Julie, BA Sports management		1		
Team V Freya, BA History of Art		1		
Team T Helen, BA Business		1		
Team U Louise, BA Sports management		1		
Team Z Violet, BA Italian		1		
Team X Vera, BA History of Ideas		1		
Team S Isabel, BA Marketing		1		
Teacher 1	1	1		
Teacher 2	1		1	
Teacher from programme			1	
Total (n = 27)	16	15	2	33

FIGURE 2
Data structure

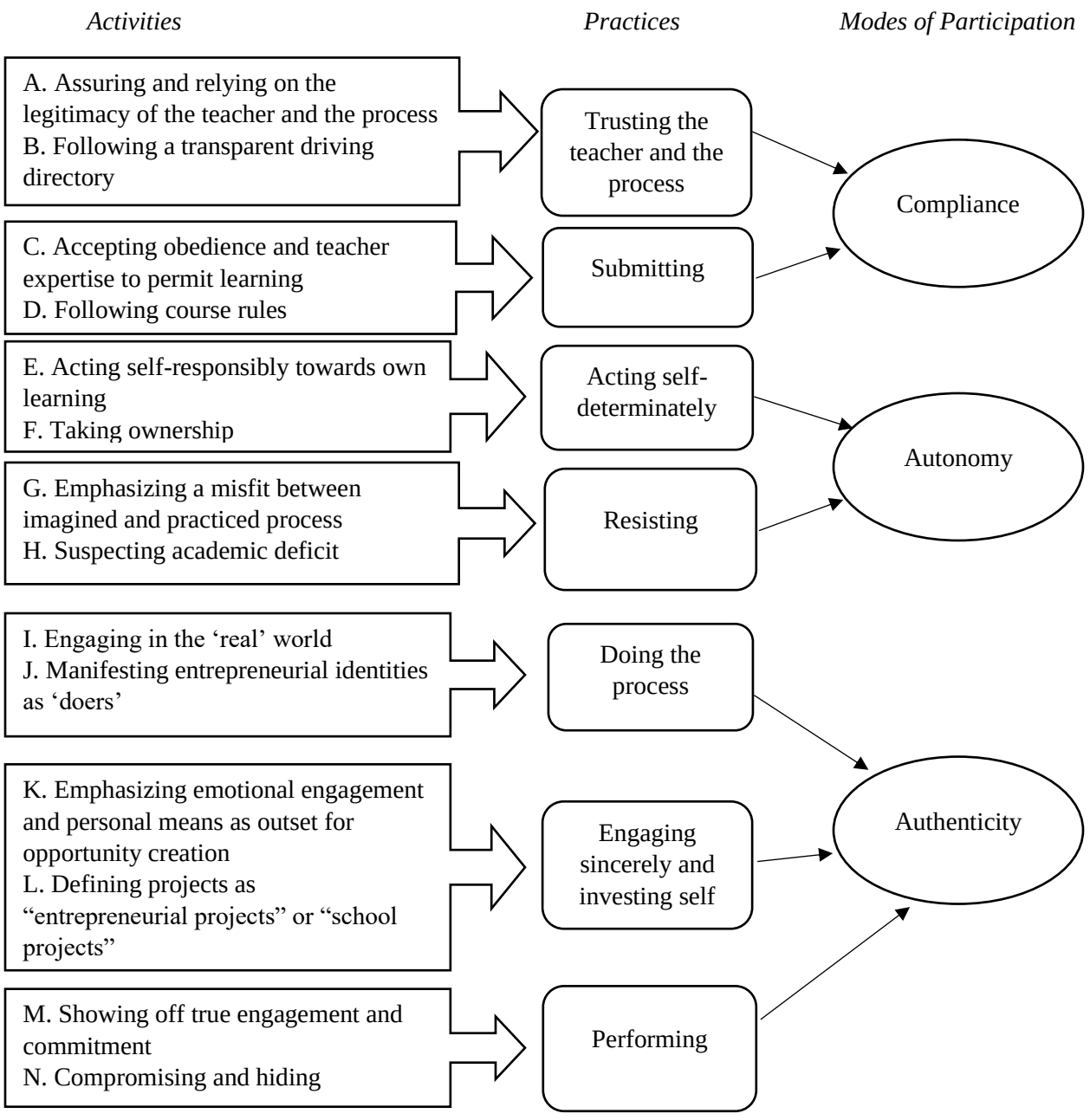


TABLE 3

Practices, Activities and Data

Practices and Activities	Illustrative Data
COMPLIANCE	
1.Trusting the teacher and the process	
A. Assuring and relying on the legitimacy of the teacher and the process	A1. "In the lecture, it is vital that the teacher is able to create the necessary legitimacy, certainty and meaningfulness to support the student's own learning process …" (description of the pedagogic model in "the process book") A2. "Teacher 2 introduces the structure of the course. The girl beside me takes the "process book" out of her bag. She quickly finds the page showing the same model, which Teacher 2 displays on the PowerPoint slide." (Field notes, Lecture I)
B. Following a transparent driving directory	B1. "I really try to be in the process. I mean, somebody has really thought about this. It is not just put together in this way for fun." (Field notes, Conversation, student talking about learning towards exams) B2. The teachers gave us a driving directory that we use to drive through and learn something by doing that." (Interview, Student recounts experiences)
2. Submitting to the process	
C. Accepting subjection and teacher expertise to permit learning	C1. "It meant that we accepted to give up our normal patterns of behaviour in a working process and take on this new thinking in order to learn the most" (Exam paper, Team Y) C2. "I regard the process as a method to push us out into the world. It requires that they [teachers] use one method to push us. Too much discussion would confuse and hinder this push."(Interview, Student recounts her experiences)
D. Following course rules	D1. "During the entire process we did not talk about ideas at all. Anytime someone was about to do it, I cut through saying: We are not allowed to do that." (Interview, Student describing her experiences after the course) D2. "We were told: Here there are no make believes. You must transform ideas into action in the real world, otherwise it does not count" (Interview, Student recounts her experiences)
AUTONOMY	
3. Acting self determinately	
E. Acting self-responsibly towards own learning	K1. You need to dare ask yourself some questions. This is what we do with the assignments … to create that reflexivity: "Okay when I do things in this way, what is it that I learn?" (Interview, Teacher 2) K2. You have to learn it yourselves from within. You have to dare be in it. Dare throw yourself into it and dare to be in the process with the expectation that it will help you proceed." (Fieldnotes feedback session II, instructor to students)

TABLE 3
Continued

Practices and Activities	Illustrative Data
F. Taking ownership	F1. 'It was only when we took ownership over the process that we started to have an actual process.' (Interview: Student recounts his experiences after the course) F2. 'About a month into the process, we found that this (the intervention) could no longer fit into the framework of the semester. Then it was just irritating to fill in the WIKI forms. It was just not relevant to our process.' (Interview, Student recounts her experiences)
4. Resistance	
G. Emphasizing a misfit between imagined and practiced process	M1. 'It was as if the education did not follow us. We followed the education.' (Interview, student recounts her experiences) M2. 'We were so afraid to do these iterations because there wasn't any time. It had to be right first time' (Interview, student recounts his experience)
H. Suspecting academic deficit	H1. 'We go through this driving directory and this is it. This is how we do it. I think it is very one-dimensional if you look at it academically' (Interview, Student recounts her experiences) H2. 'There are some elements I find quite problematic. Especially to a postgraduate course. I find it really unusual that there is this little self-reflection. You are never presented with possible holes in the theory you work with' (Interview, Student recounts her experiences)
AUTHENTICITY	
5. Doing the process	
I. Engaging in the 'real' world	I1. 'To me there is a lot of nourishment in the practical part and in doing it.' (Interview, student recounts his experiences). I2. 'This education is turned towards the world. It really drew me in" (Interview, Student recounts his experiences)
J. Manifesting entrepreneurial identities as 'doers'	J1. 'We all have this sense of enterprise. We just want to do some real stuff out in the real world' (Interview, Student recounts the team identity in the beginning of the course) J2. When working out a team identity, Team Y agrees that what they have in common is the desire to do something in the world. They agree on a team motto: "Entanglement is Development" (Field notes, Teamwork, Team Y)

TABLE 3
Continued

Practices and Activities	Illustrative Data
6. Engaging and investing the self sincerely	
K. Emphasizing emotional engagement and personal means as outset for opportunity creation	K1. 'In entrepreneurship you cannot be objectively distanced from what you are doing. It is about the individual-opportunity nexus.' (Field notes, Teacher explaining the necessity of students' personal commitment in EE, Teachers' meeting) K2. 'We tried to think effectually rather than causally. That means we did not have any goal to strive for. We only had ourselves, what we could do and who we knew' (Interview, Student recounts her experiences)
L. Defining projects as "entrepreneurial projects" or "school projects"	L1 'We made it clear to him that this is a school project. We all have other passions that we want to elaborate later' (Interview, Student recounts a conversation with a stakeholder) L2 'We always had the aim that it should certainly not be a school project. We wanted to make a serious intervention.' (Interview, student explains how the team started the entrepreneurship process
7. Performing authenticity	
M. Showing off true engagement and commitment	M1. "We have to build on our own means as an outset. This is the effectual. You cannot just adapt it to what we decide to do" (Field notes, Team Y discusses the relation between team identity and entrepreneurial opportunity). M2. "Albert says that they really need to discuss their own roles in the team. Are they entrepreneurs or are they consultants? Do they solve a stakeholder problem or do they solve their own problem as entrepreneurs?" (Field notes, Café model IV, Team T)
N. Compromising and hiding	N1. 'We were told that we should feel it in our guts. It should keep us awake at night. All five of us, we clearly sensed our own disharmonies. But, when all of us tried to agree on one, it was impossible. So, I just said ok.' (Interview, Student recounts her experiences) N2. 'We are constantly told that we should devote ourselves to the process. It is fine that you are at the stage you are. It is all right to go back. But then there are suddenly deadlines and there is something you have to achieve at a certain time.' (Interview, Student recounts her experiences)

Figure 3. The Landscape of Participation

